

THE MORNING KICKOFF

🏆 FIFA World Cup 26 — United States · Canada · Mexico · Knockout stage — Round of 16



🏠 16 teams left — 8 by Tuesday night

👑 Golden Boot: three-way tie on 7 goals

🏆 Final: Sunday 19 July, MetLife Stadium

⚡ UPSET OF THE TOURNAMENT

GIANTS FALL IN NEW JERSEY

Erling Haaland struck twice in the last eleven minutes to send Brazil home and carry Norway into a World Cup quarter-final for the first time in the nation's history — on the very pitch where the final will be played two weeks from now.

ALSO THIS MORNING

- 🏆 FIFA reversed Folarin Balogun's red-card suspension on review — the striker can face Belgium tonight.
- 🚩 England sweat on two: Quansah is suspended for the quarter-final, and Jordan Henderson hurt an arm in the post-match celebrations.
- 📅 Last two round-of-16 ties tomorrow, rest day Wednesday — then the quarter-finals begin Thursday in Boston.

INSIDE TODAY'S EDITION

- P.2 Brazil 1–2 Norway — how the five-time champions were passed off their own party
- P.3 Mexico 2–3 England — lightning, Bellingham and ten-man defiance at the Azteca
- P.4 Tonight: the Iberian derby in Dallas, then the hosts face Belgium in Seattle
- P.5 Golden Boot: Mbappé, Messi & Haaland locked on 7 — a World Cup first
- P.6 The bracket, your week of football, and the road to MetLife



Erling Haaland — two goals in eleven minutes, seven for the tournament

TONIGHT (CENTRAL EUROPE)

🇵🇹 Portugal
– Spain

🇪🇸 21:00

🇺🇸 United States
– Belgium

🇧🇪 02:00

FULL PREVIEWS
PAGE 4 →

⚡ UPSET

📍 New York New Jersey Stadium, East Rutherford



Brazil

1 – 2

FULL TIME

Norway



⚽ **Neymar** 90'+ · pen

⚽ **Haaland** 79' · header

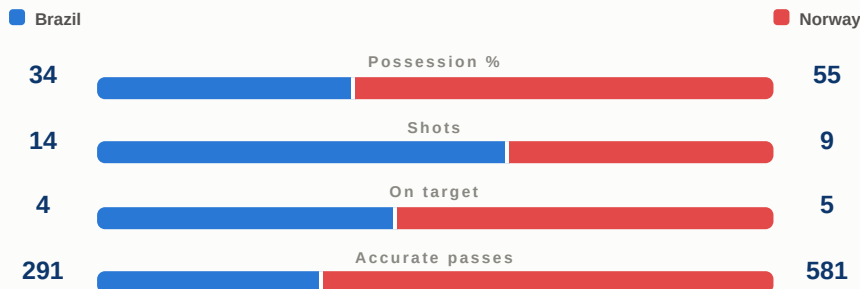
⚽ **Haaland** 90' · low drive

The stat sheet reads like a misprint: Brazil, the nation of jogo bonito, out-passed 581 to 291 in a knockout tie. Norway pressed high, moved the ball with total calm, and waited. On 79 minutes Haaland rose to head home a cross; in the 90th he collected the ball outside the box and arrowed a low drive past the goalkeeper. Brazil's 14 shots produced just four on target.

Neymar's stoppage-time penalty — his first goal of this World Cup — was no more than a farewell note. The five-time champions are out before the last eight, and a Norwegian side built on structure, running power and one unstoppable centre-forward marches on to Miami.

MATCH TIMELINE

● Norway above · ● Brazil below



★ STAR OF THE MATCH

Erling Haaland

A header and a 25-yard low drive in eleven minutes. Seven goals in five games — and next up, England in Saturday's Miami quarter-final.



Neymar, 34

His stoppage-time penalty — Brazil's only goal — may well be his final act at a World Cup.

⚡ Brazil's 34% possession — their lowest ever recorded in a World Cup match

🏆 Norway's first World Cup quarter-final in the nation's history

⚽ Haaland's brace takes him to 7 tournament goals — level with Mbappé and Messi

➔ **WHAT IT MEANS** Norway meet England in Saturday's Miami quarter-final (23:00). Brazil go home earlier than at any World Cup in a generation.

📍 Estadio Azteca, Mexico City · Att. 80,824

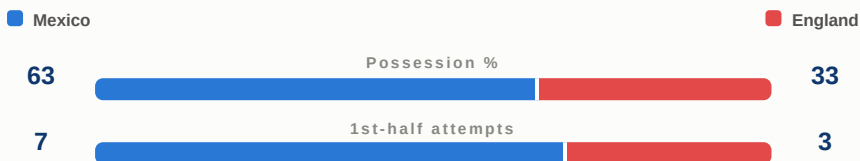


⚡ **Bellingham** 36', 38' · brace in 90 seconds
⚡ **Kane** 60' · pen

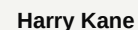
⊕ **Kane** 60' · pen

MATCH TIMELINE

● England above · ● Mexico below



Two goals in 90 seconds — the first man to score twice at the Azteca in a World Cup match since Diego Maradona in 1986.



Ice-cold from the spot in front of a hostile wall of noise. Five tournament goals — two behind the leaders.

49 England clearances, their most in a World Cup game since 1990

Monday 6 July 2026 · Edition #1 · Results & stats: ESPN, CBS Sports, Yahoo Sports, Al Jazeera, Opta Analyst, NBC, FOX Sports, Goal.com — checked morning of 6 July 2026.
Kick-off times in Central European Time unless flagged otherwise.

THE IBERIAN DERBY



21:00
 22:00
 00:30 +1
 15:00
 13:00

Kick-off 3:00 PM ET at the stadium

AT&T Stadium, Dallas

Neighbours, rivals, and two of the tournament's best attacks meet far from home. Spain have looked the more controlled side, patient and suffocating in possession; Portugal have been ruthless in transition, scoring in bursts. European champions against Iberian pride — knockout football rarely gifts a derby this big, this early.

- 👁 The midfield duel: Spain's control against Portugal's counter-punch
- 👁 Winner faces the USA or Belgium in Friday's Los Angeles quarter-final



KEY MAN · SPAIN

Mikel Oyarzabal

Four goals this tournament, quietly among the Golden Boot chasers — and Spain's most reliable big-game finisher.

HOSTS UNDER THE LIGHTS



02:00 +1
 03:00 +1
 05:30 +1
 20:00
 18:00

Kick-off 8:00 PM ET at the stadium

Lumen Field, Seattle

The co-hosts ride a wave of home support into one of America's loudest stadiums — with a boost from the committee room: FIFA reversed Folarin Balogun's red-card suspension on review, freeing the striker to lead the line. Belgium's post-golden-generation side is dangerous but beatable, and Seattle will believe.

- 👁 Balogun, reprieved, against a reshuffled Belgian back line
- 👁 A first USMNT quarter-final since 2002 is 90 minutes away



KEY MAN · UNITED STATES

Folarin Balogun

Suspension overturned, point to prove. The Seattle crowd will make him the story of the night if he scores.

EARLIER IN THE ROUND OF 16

The weekend results

Morocco 3 – 0 **Canada**

Sat 4 July

France 1 – 0 **Paraguay**

Sat 4 July

TOMORROW — THE LAST-EIGHT DECIDERS



Argentina – Egypt



18:00



Switzerland – Colombia



22:00



Kylian Mbappé

2 assists — holds the tie-breaker

7



Lionel Messi

Plays Egypt tomorrow — a chance to pull clear

7



Erling Haaland

Brace against Brazil — the man in form

7



Tie-break: assists, then minutes played. Mbappé leads on 2 assists.

⚡ NUMBERS OF THE DAY

7-7-7

Mbappé, Messi & Haaland — first World Cup ever with three players on 7+ goals

1st

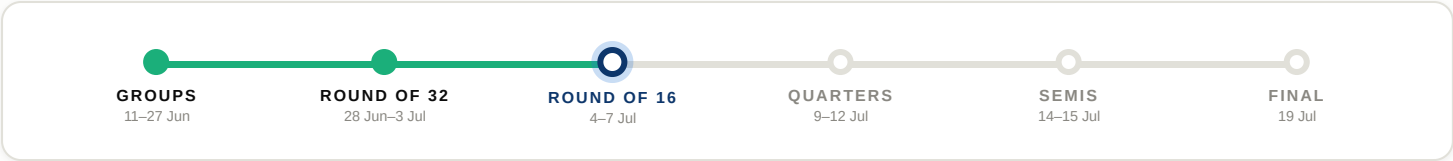
Quarter-final in Norway's history — Brazil out before the last eight

80,824

At the Azteca to see Mexico's first home World Cup defeat

33%

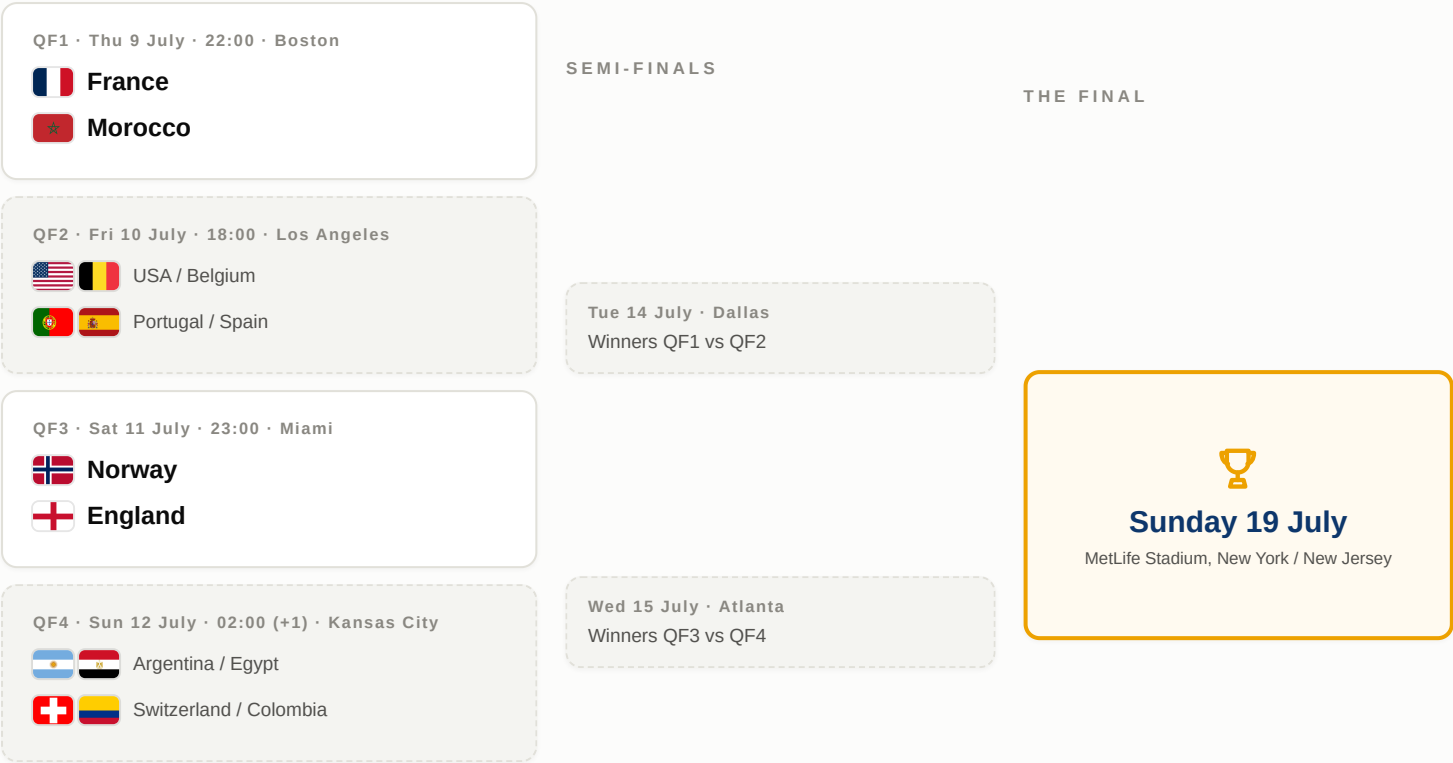
England's possession — their lowest at a World Cup since 1966



KNOCKOUT BRACKET

Quarter-finals 9–12 July · Semi-finals 14–15 July

QUARTER-FINALS



YOUR WEEK IN FOOTBALL

Monday 6 — Sunday 12 July

MON 6 Jul Portugal–Spain · 21:00 USA–Belgium · 02:00	TUE 7 Jul Argentina–Egypt · 18:00 Switzerland–Colombia · 22:00	WED 8 Jul Rest day — last 8 set	THU 9 Jul QF1 France–Morocco · 22:00	FRI 10 Jul QF2 in Los Angeles · 18:00	SAT 11 Jul QF3 Norway–England · 23:00	SUN 12 Jul QF4 in Kansas City · 02:00 (+1)
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See you tomorrow morning.

Next edition: the last two quarter-finalists — Argentina–Egypt and Switzerland–Colombia reports, plus the full last-eight preview.

Player photos: Bryan Berlin (CC BY-SA 4.0), Rolandhino1 (CC BY-SA 4.0), via Wikimedia Commons.